

RUNBOOK | INTERNAL - DO NOT FORWARD

Runbook: Churn-Save Play (Usage Drop)

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Owner	Customer Success
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Classification	Internal - do not forward
Related	New Customer Onboarding Motion, Pricing Objection Handling (SAL-PRC-2026-02), Billing Disputes runbook (OPS-BIL-2026-05)

Purpose

What to do when a workspace's usage drops sharply. A usage drop is the earliest reliable churn signal we have, usually 60 to 90 days ahead of a cancellation. This play turns the alert into a conversation before the customer has decided.

Trigger

The CS dashboard fires a **usage-drop** alert when a workspace's delivered message volume over the trailing 28 days is **40 percent or more below** its previous 28-day period, and the workspace has been active for at least 90 days. The alert lands in the account owner's queue with the two volume figures and a link to the workspace.

Alerts also fire on: no campaign sent in 30 days (Growth and above), all workflows paused for 14 days, Admin seat count dropping to one, or a downgrade request logged in Billing.

When not to run the play

- Known seasonality noted on the account (a retailer after a holiday peak). Log and skip.
- Customer told us in advance (a migration pause, a rebrand). Log and skip.
- Workspace under Acceptable Use review or suspension. Deliverability owns that conversation; do not add a second one.
- Workspace in the first 90 days. That is onboarding, not churn.

Steps

1. Diagnose before you call (same day)

Ten minutes in the admin tool. You are looking for the reason, not the confirmation.

Check	Where	What it tells you
Which channel dropped	Analytics overview, by channel	One channel down is a delivery or registration problem; all channels down is a decision
Campaign send dates	Campaigns list	Stopped abruptly on a date, or tapered
Workflow status	Workflows list	Paused workflows with Active contacts means they stopped on purpose and did not exit contacts
Authentication	Channels → Email → Authentication	A record that dropped explains an email-only decline
Delivery and complaint rates	Last five campaign reports	A bad send followed by silence means they got scared
Members and logins	Administration → Members	Last login dates. The champion may have left.
Billing	Administration → Billing	Recent overage, failed payment, open dispute, downgrade request
Tickets	Support tool	Open or recently closed tickets, especially billing and deliverability

Write one sentence in the account record: "Usage dropped because ____ (hypothesis)." You will be wrong a third of the time. Write it anyway.

2. Classify

Type	Signal	Play
Technical	One channel down, auth dropped, credential expired, webhook disabled	Fix it. Support ticket on their behalf. Call to tell them it is fixed.
Champion loss	Last login weeks ago; Admin left; new names in tickets	Find the new owner. Re-run a short onboarding.
Bad experience	Deliverability complaint, billing dispute, incident during their send	Address the experience first. Do not pitch.
Budget or value	Downgrade request, "what do we get for this," seat reduction	Value conversation. See step 4.
Silent decision	Everything paused, no tickets, no logins	Direct call. Ask.

3. Reach out (within two business days of the alert)

Email the primary contact and the Admin, if different. Short. Name the specific thing you saw: "I noticed your email volume dropped about half since mid-August and your welcome workflow has been paused since the 20th." Ask for 20 minutes. Do not attach a deck.

No reply in three business days: call. No answer: message the exec sponsor from the kickoff record. No reply after that: mark at-risk and set a 14-day recheck.

4. The conversation

Open with what you found. Then ask what changed. Then listen.

Technical. Show them it is fixed, or fix it together on the call. Confirm they know where the Authentication page is. Most technical drops end with a relieved customer.

Champion loss. Ask who owns customer messaging now. Book a 45-minute working session with that person and their Admin. Run days 6 to 30 of the onboarding motion in compressed form: one real campaign, one live workflow. Send the Campaign Analytics Glossary (CS-ANL-2025-10) afterward.

Bad experience. Acknowledge what happened without defending it. If it was a billing dispute, confirm where it stands with the Billing Disputes runbook; do not reopen the decision or promise a credit on the call. Credits under \$500 are Support's call, above that is Finance, and the customer-facing refund window is 30 days from invoice date. If it was deliverability, walk their authentication and warming with them using the Deliverability Guide (CS-DEL-2026-02).

Budget or value. Pull the numbers before the call: conversions attributed to their workflows, revenue if their goal events carry a value, campaigns sent versus plan volume. Show what the plan produced. If a product is unused, say so and offer to remove it. Removing an unused product is a save. Pushing them to keep paying for it is a cancellation in three months. Right-sizing options: Segments at \$49 if they are email only and low volume; removing Analytics if they never opened it. No discounts; anything off list goes to Finance as a deal desk request, and you should not hint at a number.

Silent decision. Ask directly: "Are you considering moving off Beacon?" You will get a real answer more often than you expect. If yes, ask what the alternative solves that we do not. Log it verbatim for Product. Then ask for a 30-day pilot of whatever they think is missing before they switch.

5. Act and follow up

Within one business day of the call, send a summary: what you heard, what you will do, by when. Do the things. Recheck usage at 14 and 28 days. Update the account record with the outcome: saved, right-sized, at-risk, churned, with the reason in one sentence.

Do not

- Do not lead with a discount you do not have. Finance owns pricing. See Pricing Objection Handling (SAL-PRC-2026-02).
- Do not promise a feature or a date. Log the request; Product prioritizes.
- Do not promise credits. Route to Billing Disputes.

- Do not send a survey instead of calling. The survey tells you they are unhappy; you already know.
- Do not run the play on a workspace under Acceptable Use review.

Escalation

- Budget conversations that need anything off list: deal desk request to Finance.
- Customer names a competitor and a switch date: CS lead plus the account executive, same day.
- Customer's drop traces to a Beacon incident: link the write-up, involve Finance for any service terms in the order form. Do not decide it yourself.
- Workspace with more than \$5,000 monthly plan fees: CS lead joins the call.

Done when

- Diagnosis sentence in the account record.
- Type classified.
- Customer reached (or three attempts logged plus exec sponsor).
- Summary sent within one business day of the call.
- Outcome recorded at 28 days.

Revision history

Version	Date	Change
v1.2	2025-07-08	Changed trigger from 30 to 40 percent to cut false alarms
v1.3	2025-12-02	Added champion loss type
v1.4	2026-04-22	Added "do not run" cases; aligned billing lines with OPS-BIL-2026-05